Title: Australia's National Parks

Subtitle: Are we protecting the right places, and who uses them?

1. Introduction



Australia protects more than a fifth of its land. This page looks at how much is national park, where it is, and who lives near it

2. National parks are only part of the protected land

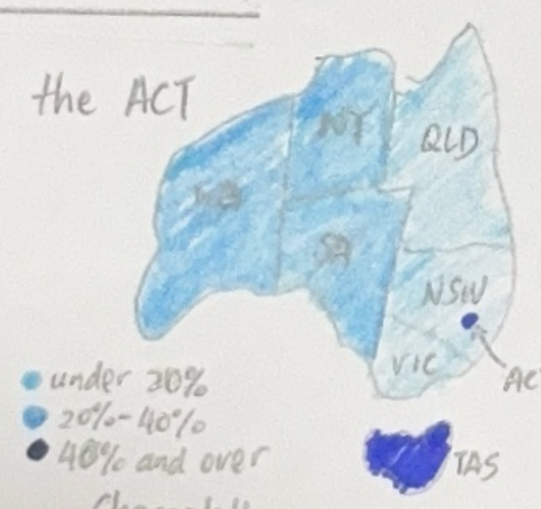
22.6% of Australia is protected. Only 5.5% is national park.



Waffle chart. Share of land by protection type, CAPAD 2024

3. Not every state protects the same share

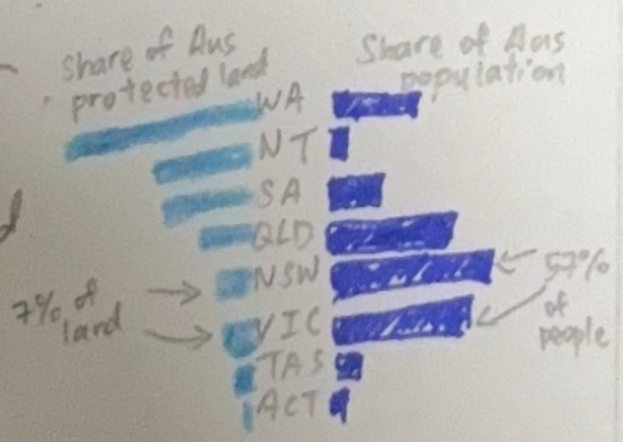
Tasmania protects 43%, the ACT 56%, Queensland 9%

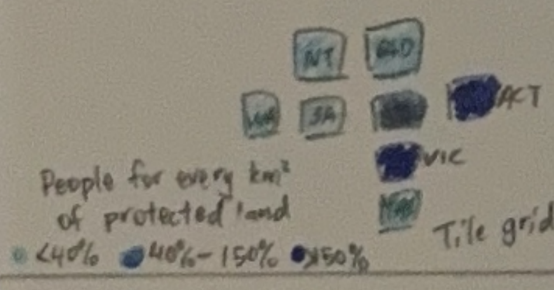


Choropleth map, % of each state's land protected, CAPAD 2024

4. Most protected land is far from most people.

NSW and Victoria: 57% of people, 7% of protected land



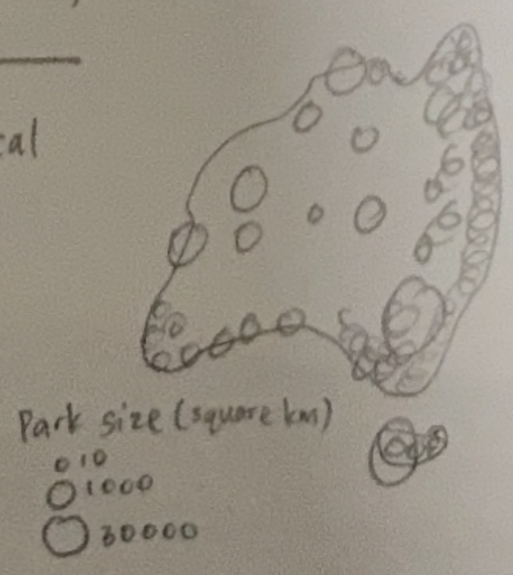


Butterfly chart. CAPAD, ABS.

Tile grid map

5. Most national parks are small, and a few are giants

About 800 parks. The typical one is 65 km²



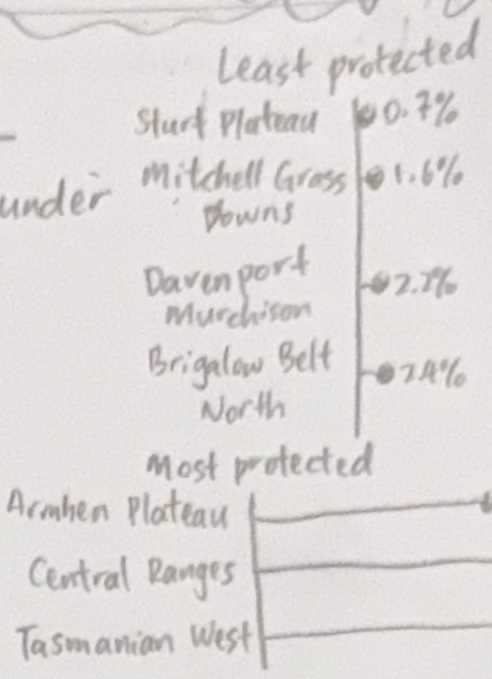
Next page

6. Is it the right land?

27 of 87 regions have under 10% protected.



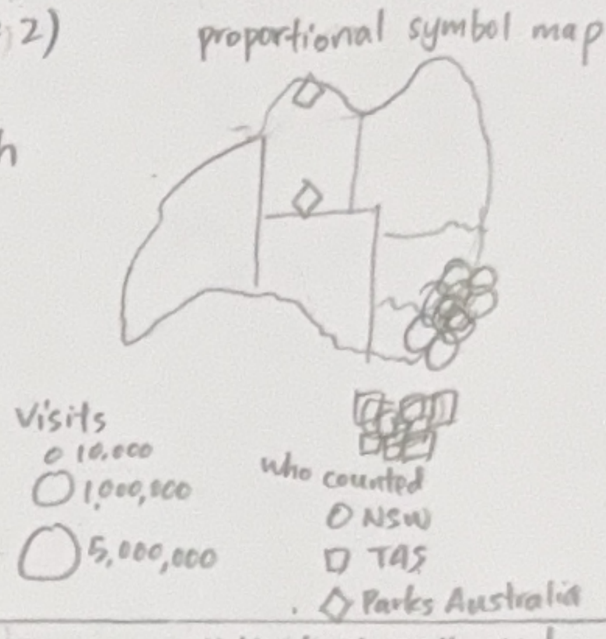
Heatmap



Lollipop chart

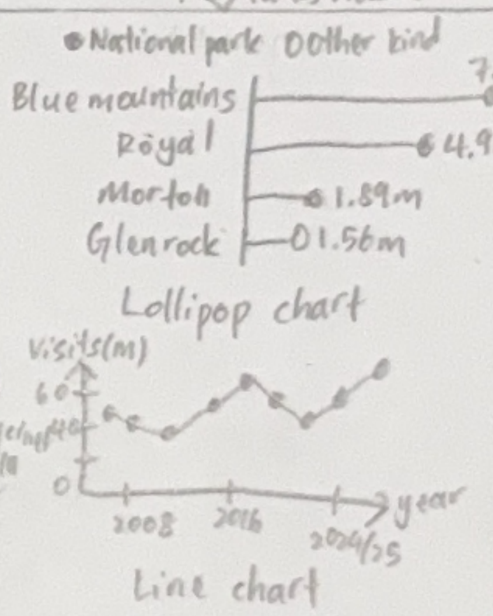
7. Who Actually Goes? (1 of 2)

Only three agencies publish park-by-park counts, and they count differently.

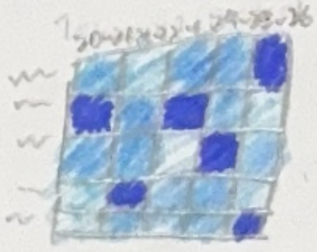


8. Who Actually Goes? (2 of 2)

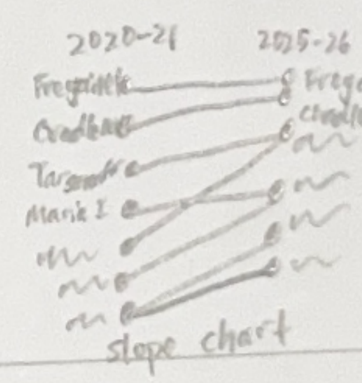
NSW had 65.6 million visits in 2024/25. Uluru is at 68% of 2018-19.



Lollipop chart



Heat map

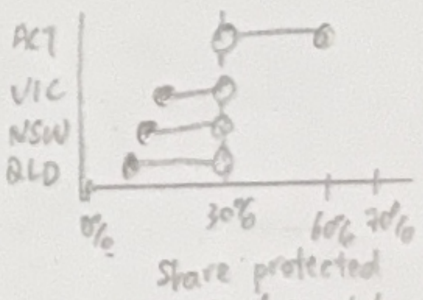


Slope chart

Line chart

9. The road to 30%

Queensland and NSW are about 20 points short of the goal.



Connected dot plot. Each state vs the 30% goal. CAPAD, DCCEEW.

10. What it adds up to.

National Parks are 5.5% of Australia. Protection is uneven. The question is not only how much, but which land.

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